

Mikaela Mäensivu

Design Engineer · 0 → 1 Consumer AI · Built for High-Velocity Teams

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PROFILE

The designer a founding team hires when there is no one to hand the work to. Eight years designing consumer products — the flows, the systems, the brand, the actual pixels — and the range to take them into production myself. At Winged I designed every surface of an AI matchmaking agent that lives in your text messages, then wrote most of the code behind it. I am fastest at 0 → 1, where the interface and the system are one design problem.

CORE SKILLS

Product Design	End-to-end product and UI/UX design, wireframe through shipped UI · design systems, tokens, and component libraries · interaction and motion design · responsive web and native iOS · prototyping in Figma and in code
Brand & Visual	Brand identity and art direction · marketing and campaign creative · editorial and print layout · social and content design · pitch decks and investor materials · generative image and video · Figma, Framer, Adobe Creative Suite
AI & Agents	Designing for agents: conversation, voice, and trust · multi-agent orchestration and tool calling · agent memory and context design · MCP servers and tooling · Claude and the Anthropic API, OpenAI, and open models · realtime voice agents · prompt design and evals
Build	React and TypeScript · Swift and SwiftUI, shipped to the App Store · Node.js · Postgres and Supabase · Twilio SMS and voice
Workflow	AI-native development in Claude Code and Codex · a heavily customized toolchain of MCP servers, plugins, and skills · spec-driven repos · 0 → 1 definition, roadmap, and specs · leading small engineering teams

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & CEO · Winged

Sep 2025 – Present · San Francisco / Helsinki

Antler-backed AI matchmaking agent — the product is the agent, not the app.

- Designed every surface of the product — onboarding, conversational and voice flows, the iOS app, the marketing site, and the brand and design system underneath it — then wrote most of the code across three production repos to ship it.
- Designed a product with no app to open. Instead of a screen, the canvas was a text thread and a phone call: I designed one agent with a consistent voice and character across SMS, voice, and iOS, replacing the signup form with a single conversation.
- Made an AI product people trust with something intimate — designing the disclosure, consent, and confirmation moments so users hand over dating decisions willingly, then shipping the SwiftUI app to the App Store.
- Read the market and rebuilt the product in two weeks. Nobody downloads a new dating app, and software was already moving from apps to agents — so I scrapped the app and relaunched Winged as an agent that texts and calls you. Now in early access in SF and Helsinki with **1,600 users**.
- Designed and built Winged Max, the desktop version — a computer-use agent running over iPhone Mirroring on Mac that operates inside apps on the user's behalf, acting across apps that were never built for automation (built first for the dating use case).

AI, Product & Design Consultant · Architechtura

Jul 2022 – Sep 2025 · Miami / Remote

- Took four AI products from idea to launch for startups and established brands: a realtime voice companion, a spoken-language tutor, a multi-model LLM workspace holding shared context across Mistral, ChatGPT, and Claude, and an AI mental-health coach — design, interface, and integration all mine.
- Rebuilt major Shopify storefronts around conversion, with measurable gains in experience and revenue, alongside positioning and full-funnel growth.

COO, Product & Design · Blocktickets

Sep 2022 – Nov 2024 · New York

Mobile-first live-event ticketing built to beat Ticketmaster on price transparency and bot-proof security.

- Owned the entire product experience — seat-map builder, season and group ticketing, flex packs, resale, and a two-click checkout — from roadmap and specs through to the pixels that shipped.
- Led a two-person engineering team and built the internal tooling across lead-gen, fundraising, and support that let a company that small run much larger.
- Raised \$600K+ for product development, and wrote the pitch decks and investor materials that closed it.

Head of Brand & Marketing, Visual Design (Sep 2022 – Aug 2023) — built the visual identity, campaign creative, and the product's design language.

Co-Founder & COO · Supernovas Labs

Sep 2021 – Sep 2022 · Helsinki

- Co-founded a decentralized social network funded through DeSo's \$50M Octane Fund (a16z, Sequoia, Coinbase Ventures). Owned product, growth, and operations; grew it to 10K daily active users.

Growth Hacking Lead · Truly Agency

Sep 2020 – Sep 2021 · Helsinki

- Ran weekly growth sprints across the client portfolio, pairing design and technical execution with strategy across paid and organic channels.

Talent Acquisition & Stakeholder Management · Goldman Sachs

Sep 2017 – Jun 2020 · New York

- Owned senior stakeholder relationships across three divisions — partnering with engineering, product, and business leaders in Consumer & Commercial Banking, Securities, and Compliance to translate what they needed into teams that delivered.
- Built the teams behind Marcus and Apple Card, Goldman's flagship consumer platforms — learning fintech architecture, regulatory constraint, and how engineering orgs get assembled.

EARLIER

Growth Hacker, Icebreaker.vc — data-driven growth experiments across the portfolio.

2020 · Helsinki

Visual Designer & Community Manager, Girls Who Travel — grew a global community zero to 80K organically; +192% YoY on Instagram.

2018–2021 · Orlando

EDUCATION

Rollins College — B.A., English Language & Literature; focal points in Economics, Studio Art, and Political Science.

Winter Park, FL

Yale University — The Science of Well-Being, Executive Education.

2020